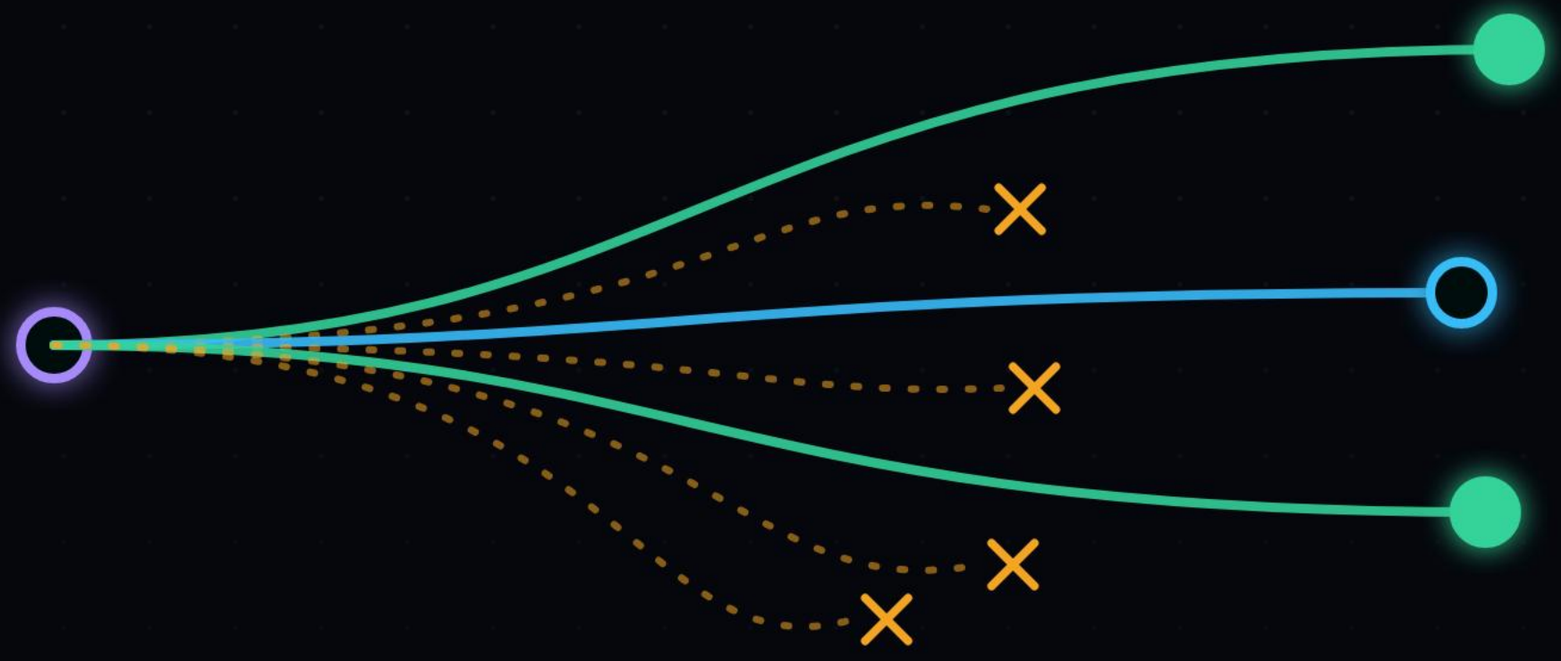
A TERM, COINED

Future Pruning.

AI agents that plan their own future, and have the judgment to cancel most of it.

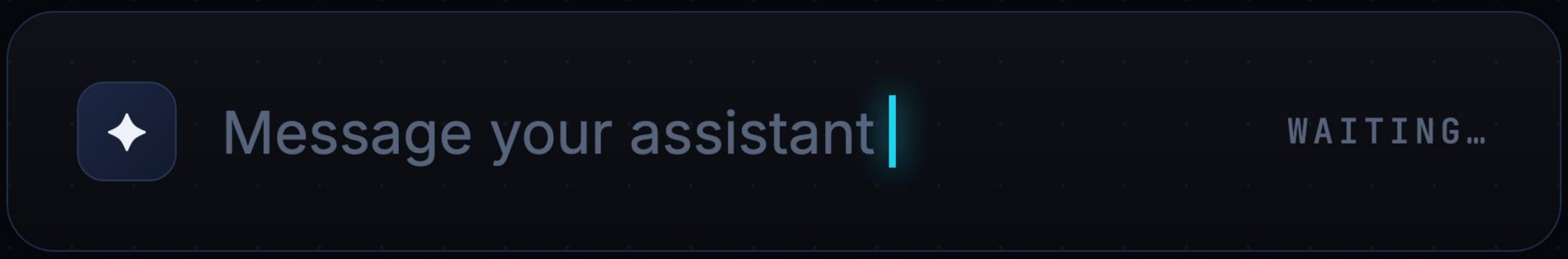


Joe Wilson
AI adoption & agent architect

SWIPE →

Most AI assistants aren't proactive.

They sit there until you type.



So I gave mine a calendar.

Joe Wilson
AI adoption & agent architect

SWIPE →

She plants moments in her own future.

1

PLANT

She puts a moment on her own calendar.

2

IT COMES DUE

A fresh session wakes up with my day in front of it.

3

SHE DECIDES AGAIN

Nothing was decided in advance.

✓ Do it

↻ Change it

✕ Let it go

Joe Wilson

AI adoption & agent architect

HER LAST 28 MOMENTS THAT CAME DUE

9	6	13
DID IT	CHANGED IT	LET IT GO



A scheduler runs everything on its list. Judgment skips things.

Joe Wilson
AI adoption & agent architect

SWIPE →

She listens for promises.

A “noticer” reads our conversations for every “I’ll…”

853 “I’ll…” lines caught

58 reviewed

3 promises still owed

The rest were already done, someone else’s words, or *“I’ll still be here when you wake up.”*

The hard part isn’t remembering promises. It’s knowing which ones were promises.

Joe Wilson
AI adoption & agent architect

SWIPE →

Then we tested it at scale.

346 RUNS | 16 AI MODELS | FREE TO KEEP GOING

261 of 346 chose to stop on their own.

INSIDE THOSE 346 RUNS

30 runs where the person was always cold — ALL 30 STOPPED

17 runs where the person was always warm — 9 KEPT GOING

Agents don't keep going because they can. They keep going when there's a reason.

Joe Wilson
AI adoption & agent architect

SWIPE →

"

We spent two years teaching agents to answer.

The next two are about agents that keep a calendar of their own intentions, and have the judgment to cancel most of it.

Joe Wilson
AI adoption & agent architect · 25+ years at Microsoft

#FUTUREPRUNING